The screensaver

Leave the desk for ten minutes and the desktop dissolves into a screensaver: your own screen, blurred and drifting behind a slow liquid warp, with the time and date floating over it. Any key, click, or mouse movement brings it straight back — nothing is asked for, so it is decoration, not a lock. **Ctrl + Shift + S** shows it immediately.

Change the idle time (or turn it off) in **Settings → Appearance → Screensaver**. Video playback holds it off: an app that tells the desktop it is playing something — Chrome, Firefox, a video player — keeps the screensaver away for as long as it says so, so a film watched without touching the mouse is never interrupted.

For **aerial footage** in place of the warp, drop a video file in `~/.local/share/starling/aerials/`; the screensaver dissolves into it and loops it. Starling ships none of its own — the warp needs no assets, and the clips worth watching are large. Any shape works: letterbox bars are cropped away and the picture fills the screen.